



# CHAMPIONS

## BT-KPMG QUANTITATIVE WINNERS

### ► BEST LARGE INDIAN BANK

ICICI Bank

### ► BEST MID-SIZED BANK

Bank of Maharashtra

### ► BEST LARGE FOREIGN BANK

JP Morgan

### ► BEST SMALL BANK

Karur Vysya Bank

### ► BEST SMALL FINANCE BANK

Ujjivan Small Finance Bank

### ► BEST LARGE NBFC

Bajaj Finance

ability to redefine excellence in the face of adversity. (See graphic 'Celebrating the Champions').

## THE CHALLENGE OF LIABILITIES

There has been sluggish momentum in mobilising deposits by banks—and this has been a result of multiple challenges. These include a slowdown in the economy (the RBI has projected a lower GDP of 6.6% in FY25); delayed government spending during elections; and other liquidity challenges in the economy. The buoyancy in the stock markets after the pandemic has also attracted young savers to equity and mutual funds because of higher returns, further aggravating banks' struggles in mobilising deposits.

Naveen Kulkarni, Chief Investment Officer at Axis Securities PMS, says banks have sharpened their focus on deposit accretion to support the credit growth buoyancy. "In the quarter gone by, the pace of deposit growth has improved, with growth led by both CASA and term deposits (TDS). We believe banks will continue to focus on deposit mobilisation and eventually credit and deposit growth will align," he explains.

Akshay Gupta, Managing Director & CEO of Prime Research & Advisory, doesn't believe that there is any structural challenge for banks to mo-